The Form composition model · Frame · Cell · Tile

Author once. Read anywhere.

A slide is no longer content with chrome bolted on. It is a Frame that divides the canvas into Cells, and each Cell holds a Tile. Author the Tiles once; a consumer picks a Frame, and the same Tiles re-flow to meet the reader where they are.

Section 01

The anatomy

Every slide resolves to the same three Cells.

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

Masthead

01 The band across the top. Its lede holds the kicker and title Tiles; its bay holds the meta and status Tiles. This slide's bay carries the deck's `meta:` line — the mark above it sits in no band at all.

Stage

02 The deterministic content region between the bands — the box a component fills. It computes to pixels before its content lays out, which is why a chart finally has somewhere to live.

Footer

03 Three reserved zones that never collide: the footer text on the left, the section progress rail in the center, the page number on the right.

Ten Tiles fill those Cells — sourced, not placed.

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

Masthead Tiles

Kicker, title, meta, and a status chip. Each knows its own source: the title from your `## heading`, the meta from front matter, the status from a class.

Stage Tile

The single `content` Tile — your component, which owns its own internal layout inside that Cell.

Footer Tiles

Footer text, the progress rail, and pagination — all derived. Dividers become sections; `paginate` becomes the page number.

Frame-anchored Tiles

The logo and the watermark dock in no band. Each holds its own Cell, pinned to the slide — which is why the mark rides the corner above the bay.

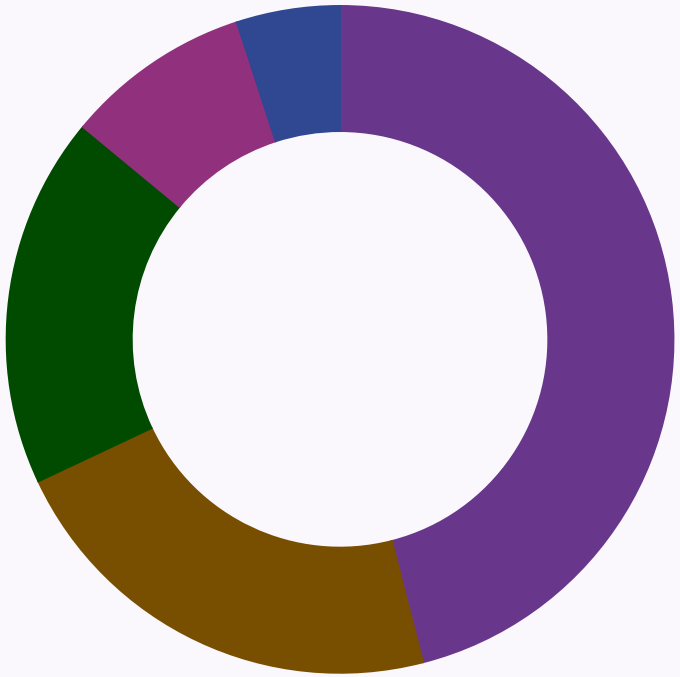
Section 02

Charts live in the Cell now

H1 FY26 · 1,840 person-hours

The quarter went where the roadmap did not.

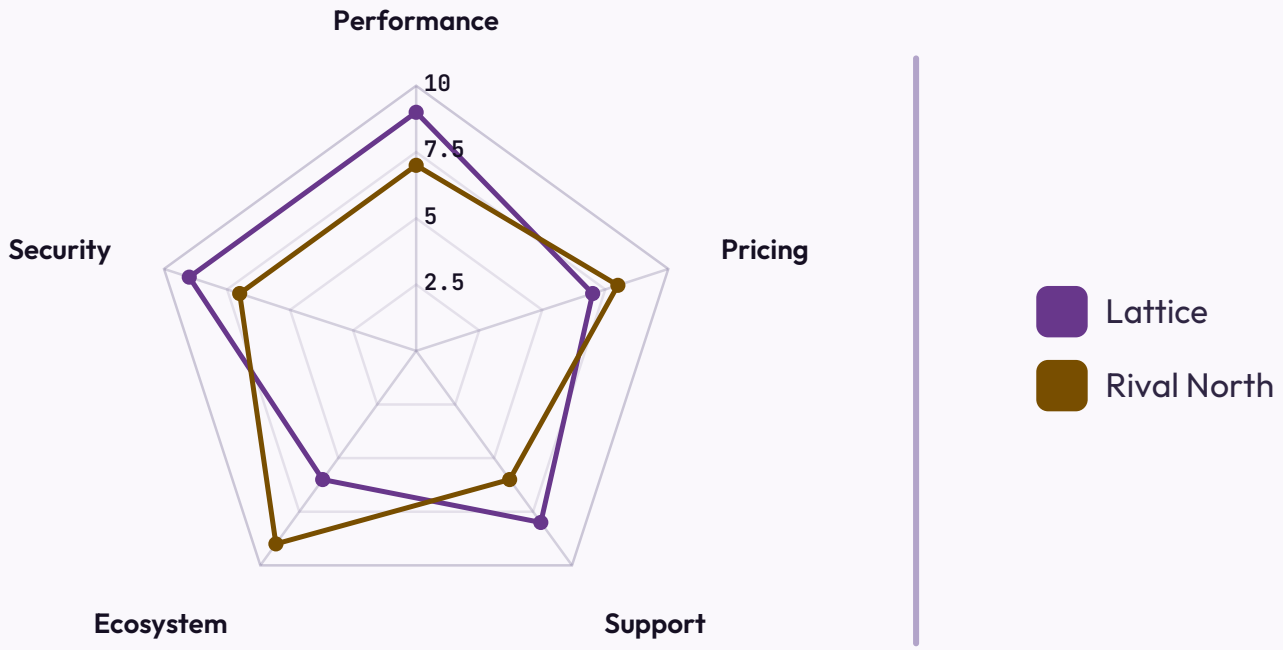
COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN



Signal Intake build	46%
Scoring policy work	22%
Decision Log integration	18%
Stakeholder alignment	9%
Toil and on-call	5%

The donut and the radar both fill their Cell.

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN



Why this is the proof

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

A Cell is a box with real pixels, so a chart has somewhere to live.

The old flex column made the content box content-driven — its height was whatever the content turned out to be. A donut sized against that collapsed to a thumbnail; a radar squeezed to a fragment. The stage Cell computes to pixels first, so the chart sizes into a box that already exists. Same authoring, full-size figure.

Section 03

Fill is the difference

fill-center · the Tile sits in the center of its Cell

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

Fill discipline puts a short Tile where the eye expects it.

A short occupant given `fill-center` sits in the middle of the stage Cell. The chrome Cells are reserved above and below; the stage centers what it holds. This is the board-deck read — composed, not pinned.

fill-anchor · the same Tile, the fill rule changed

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

The same Tile, the same box, a different fill.

`fill-anchor` pins the very same occupant to the foot of the stage Cell. Nothing about the geometry moved — the Cell is the identical box. Fill is a property the Cell carries and the author selects, which is the difference between a grid of correct boxes and a board deck.

Section 04

The chrome Tiles

Context · The bay and the watermark

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

The bay carries the meta and the status; the watermark echoes the section.

This slide is marked `confidential`, so a status chip docks in the masthead bay instead of stamping a corner. The `meta:` line rides the bay beside it. Behind this text, the watermark Tile ghosts the section number — derived from the deck's dividers, the same source the progress rail reads.

Evidence · One source, three paths

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

One flag resolves identically across every render path.

The toggle becomes the form class in the owned engine, marp-cli, and the runtime alike.

1	3	0
FRONT-MATTER FLAG	RENDER PATHS IN STEP	SLIDES HAND-TAGGED

Section 05

The payoff

The payoff · One block of content

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

Author this claim once, and let the consumer choose its Frame.

The next three slides carry this exact claim. Nothing in the words changes. Only the Frame does.

KEY INSIGHT

Net revenue retention held at 114% across the March cohort. Expansion is concentrated — three segments drive 80% of the gain — so the base compounds without new-logo dependency.

Frame · standard

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

The standard Frame: band, bay, footer rail.

KEY INSIGHT

Net revenue retention held at 114% across the March cohort. Expansion is concentrated — three segments drive 80% of the gain — so the base compounds without new-logo dependency.

Read as a working slide. The full chrome orients a reader paging through the deck.

Frame · minimal

COMPOSITION MODEL · 2026-06-15
OWNER · S. ADEN

The minimal Frame: band and bay, the rail dropped.

KEY INSIGHT

Net revenue retention held at 114% across the March cohort. Expansion is concentrated — three segments drive 80% of the gain — so the base compounds without new-logo dependency.

Same Tiles, a quieter Frame. The consumer chose to suppress the progress rail — the words never moved.

NET REVENUE RETENTION

114%

A sovereign Frame: the masthead and footer Cells are suppressed and the canvas is re-carved.

Expansion is concentrated in three segments

They drive 80% of the gain, so the base compounds without new-logo dependency.

Held above 110% across the cohort

That clears the investor threshold for capital-efficient growth.

One claim, four Frames

The author never rewrote it. The consumer selected the structure each time.

Author once; read anywhere.

One block of Tiles, any Frame the consumer selects.